

PROGRESSION · TIMELINE · STRUCTURE

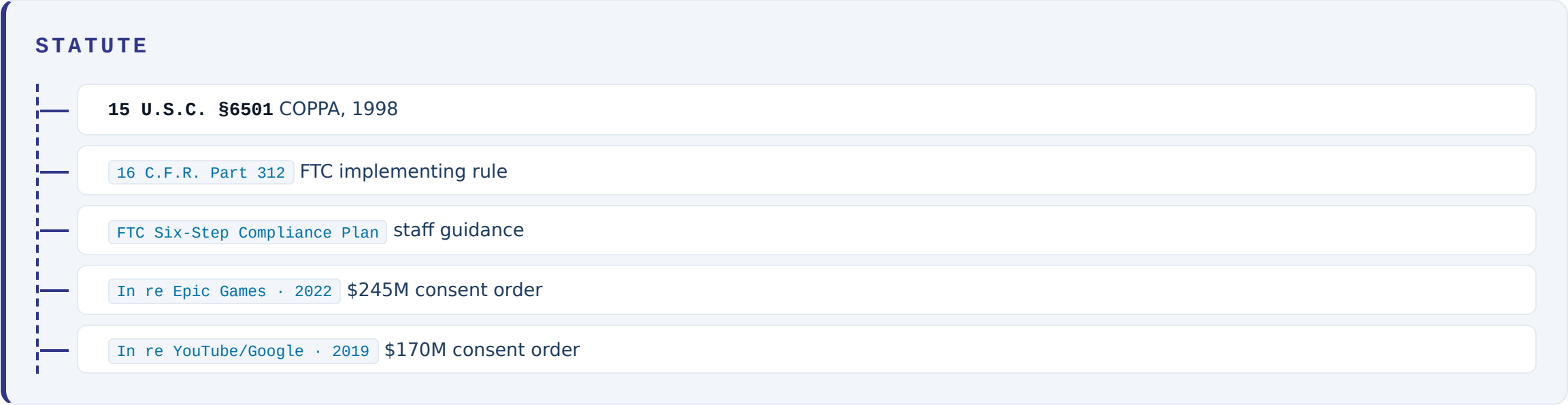
authority-chain

Provenance chain — statute to regulation to guidance to case, walked in order.

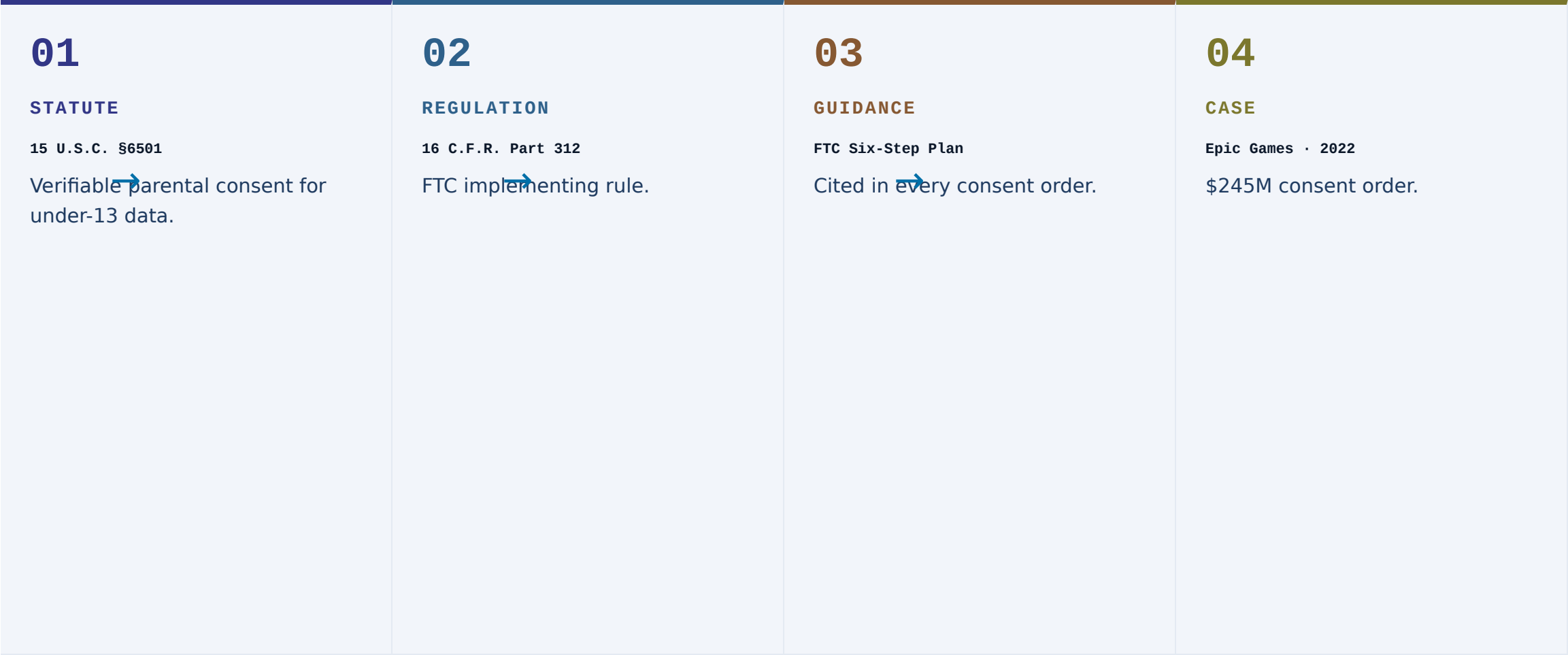
COPPA — the chain, tier by tier.



COPPA — one statute, many branches.



COPPA — statute through case, left to right.



When NOT to reach for authority-chain.

Flat list of citations. If the rows have no tier hierarchy, use `list-criteria` or `regulatory-update`. authority-chain earns its chrome only when the descent from statute to case is the point.

Missing citation chip. The inline-code citation is the row's anchor; without it the gloss reads as opinion. Always cite, even for guidance and case rows.

Out-of-order tiers. The chain reads as a descent: statute first, case last. Reversing it or skipping a tier breaks the metaphor the audience is using to follow you.

See also.

RELATED COMPONENTS

`regulatory-update` — period-bounded changelog rather than a single rule's lineage

`list-criteria` — flat enumeration of requirements without tier hierarchy

`timeline` — the sequence is chronological events, not legal tiers

`list-steps` — the rows are procedural steps rather than authority tiers